

WAAS PLATFORM — MVP BUILD BRIEF

Project Outline for Developer

Niche website rental platform for trade businesses

R300/month per client · HVAC niche first · South Africa

Confidential · Version 1.0 · 2025

1. Executive Summary

This document is a complete project brief for the development of an MVP Website-as-a-Service (WaaS) platform. The platform allows trade and professional businesses to get a niche-specific, fully branded website live in under 15 minutes — for R300 per month. The client enters their details through a guided onboarding flow, the template auto-populates with their content and branding, and the site goes live immediately after payment.

The MVP targets three niches: HVAC and plumbing contractors, dental and private medical practices, and real estate agents. Development begins with the HVAC niche only. The other niches follow once revenue validates the model.

Business model

- Website-as-a-service subscription
- R300/month per client
- HVAC & plumbing — first niche
- 6-step onboarding to live site
- South Africa launch, expand later

Core MVP features

- 6-step guided onboarding
- Brand colour picker (6 presets)
- Auto-populated template fields
- Floating WhatsApp button
- Suburb tag cloud + service area
- Pricing transparency per service
- Response time trust badge
- Static testimonials → Google reviews later
- PayFast recurring billing
- Google Analytics traffic dashboard

2. Required Tech Stack

The developer must use the following stack. Do not substitute without written approval.

Feature	Description	Priority
Next.js 14+	Frontend framework — App Router, SSR for SEO	Required
TailwindCSS	Styling — utility-first, fast to build	Required
Supabase	Auth, Postgres database, file storage	Required
Node.js / API Routes	Backend logic via Next.js API routes	Required
PayFast	South African recurring billing and subscription management	Required
Google Analytics 4	Client traffic data — injected per site via GA4 Measurement ID	Required
Vercel	Hosting and deployment — seamless Next.js integration	Required
Resend or Sendgrid	Transactional email (confirmation, receipts, dashboard login)	Required
Color Thief (JS)	Planned v2 — logo colour extraction. Not in MVP scope.	V2 only
Google Places API	Planned v2 — live Google reviews widget. Not in MVP scope.	V2 only
Meta Graph API	Planned v2 — Facebook/Instagram traffic. Not in MVP scope.	V2 only

3. System Architecture Overview

The platform has three distinct layers. The developer must build all three.

3.1 Public marketing site

- Landing page explaining the product, pricing, and how it works
- Call to action linking to the onboarding flow
- Simple, no login required

3.2 Client onboarding flow (6 steps)

A multi-step web form that collects all information needed to populate the client's website template. Steps are:

1. Step 1 — Business basics: trading name, tagline, owner name, year founded, business type, jobs completed, about paragraph
2. Step 2 — Services, trust and area: services offered, starting prices per service, certifications, insurance toggle, guarantee toggle, emergency toggle, free quote toggle, primary city, suburbs served (tag input), written testimonials (3 rows)
3. Step 3 — Branding: logo upload (PNG/SVG, max 5MB), brand colour picker (6 presets: Navy, Red, Green, Amber, Purple, Teal), hero photo upload (optional), owner photo upload (optional)
4. Step 4 — Contact: primary phone, WhatsApp number, business email, response time selector, operating hours per day (Mon–Sun), Facebook URL, Instagram URL, Facebook Pixel ID (optional)
5. Step 5 — Payment: blurred site preview, order summary, PayFast card payment integration, trust signals
6. Step 6 — Publish: full unlocked site preview, subdomain selector or custom domain input, terms checkbox, publish button

3.3 Client dashboard

- Unique login per client via Supabase Auth
- Sidebar navigation: Dashboard, Traffic, Edit website, Photos, Google reviews (connect prompt), Facebook, Billing, Settings, Support
- Dashboard home: welcome banner on first login, 4 stat cards (visitors today, enquiries this week, Google rating placeholder, next billing date), setup checklist (3 items), visitor chart (weekly bar chart via GA4), traffic sources breakdown
- Edit website: client can update any text field, toggle features, change colour preset, re-upload photos
- Photos: upload up to 6 job photos — shown in gallery section on published site
- Google reviews: connect prompt — guides client to add Google Place ID. Placeholder until connected.
- Billing: shows plan, next charge date, card details, cancel button

3.4 Admin panel (internal — for your use only)

- View all active clients and subscription status
- See each client's site URL and onboarding completion
- Manually trigger re-publish if needed
- Cancel or pause subscriptions

4. Onboarding Flow — Detailed Specification

The onboarding is the most critical part of the product. It must feel fast, guided, and satisfying. Follow these requirements exactly.

UX requirements — non-negotiable

- Progress bar at the top showing percentage complete and step X of 6
- Stepper showing all 6 step labels with done / active / upcoming states
- All progress auto-saved to Supabase on each Continue click — client can return and resume
- Back button available from Step 2 onwards
- Step 5 (Payment) stepper circle shows 'R' not a number and renders in amber colour
- Validation on Continue — required fields highlighted if empty, no silent failures
- Mobile-responsive — the majority of HVAC clients will onboard on their phone

Step 3 — brand colour picker spec

- Display 6 colour swatches in a grid: Navy (#1e3a5f), Red (#C0392B), Green (#1A7A4A), Amber (#BA7517), Purple (#534AB7), Teal (#0F6E56)
- Selected swatch gets a 2px border in the platform accent colour
- On selection, the live preview panel (shown on Step 5) updates its colour scheme to match
- Colour choice is stored as a string key (e.g. 'navy') and mapped to a CSS theme class on the published site
- Note to developer: AI colour extraction from logo is NOT in MVP scope — use the preset picker only

Step 5 — payment screen spec

- Left column: blurred preview of the client's populated site with a 'Unlock to publish' lock pill overlay
- Right column: order summary (R300 + Included items + Waived setup fee), card input form, PayFast integration
- On successful payment: animate transition to Step 6 (Publish) automatically — no manual click needed
- On failed payment: show inline error with reason, allow retry — do NOT redirect or lose form state
- Trust signals below pay button: 30-day refund, no contracts, local support

Step 6 — publish screen spec

- Show full unlocked preview of the client's site (no blur)
- Subdomain input: [clientname].siterent.co.za — validate uniqueness against Supabase
- Custom domain field: optional text input — show DNS setup instructions after publish if used
- Terms checkbox must be checked before publish button is enabled

→ On publish: create subdomain record, deploy site, send confirmation email, redirect to dashboard

5. HVAC Website Template — Section Specification

The template is a single Next.js page rendered per client using their Supabase data. Every section below must be built. Sections with a toggle in the onboarding are conditionally rendered based on that toggle.

Feature	Description	Priority
Navigation bar	Logo (uploaded), business name, anchor links to sections, click-to-call phone button	Required
Hero section	Headline with city auto-populated, tagline, response time badge, emergency banner (conditional), dual CTAs: 'Get a free quote' and WhatsApp button (pre-filled message)	Required
Trust bar	Years experience (calculated), jobs completed, certifications as badges, insured badge (conditional), guarantee badge (conditional)	Required
Services section	Cards for each selected service — icon, name, description, starting price if entered, WhatsApp CTA per card. Emergency card with red styling (conditional)	Required
Pricing guide	Table of services with starting prices — only shows rows where price was entered. Free quote CTA below.	Required
Suburb tag cloud	All suburbs entered as styled tags. Headline with primary city auto-populated.	Required
Testimonials	3 testimonial cards with client name, suburb, and quote. Replaced by Google reviews widget in v2.	Required
About section	Owner name, year founded, about paragraph, optional owner photo, optional business type context	Required
Photo gallery	Up to 6 job photos uploaded from dashboard. Section hidden if no photos uploaded.	Required
Contact section	Contact form (name, phone, service, suburb — 4 fields), operating hours display, embedded Google Map from address, email, social links	Required
Footer	Logo, business name, phone, email, social icons, privacy policy link (auto-generated), POPIA notice, operating hours summary	Required

Feature	Description	Priority
Floating WhatsApp button	Fixed bottom-right, always visible, pre-filled message from onboarding	Required
Facebook Pixel	Injected into page head if Pixel ID was entered during onboarding	Required
Google Analytics	GA4 tag injected per site using client's Measurement ID	Required
Schema markup	LocalBusiness JSON-LD schema auto-generated from onboarding data — injected in head	Required
Meta title + description	Auto-generated: '[Business name] — HVAC & Plumbing in [City]' pattern, editable from dashboard	Required
SSL certificate	Included via Vercel — applies to both subdomain and custom domain	Required
Privacy policy page	Auto-generated /privacy page using business name — POPIA compliant	Required

6. Database Schema — Supabase

Use Supabase Postgres. The developer has discretion on exact column naming but must capture all fields listed. Row-level security must be enabled — each client can only read and write their own data.

6.1 clients table

- id (uuid, primary key)
- user_id (references Supabase auth.users)
- business_name, trading_name, tagline, owner_name, year_founded, business_types (array), jobs_completed, about_text
- services (array of selected service keys), service_prices (jsonb — key: service, value: starting price)
- certifications (array), is_insured (bool), has_guarantee (bool), guarantee_period, has_emergency (bool), offers_free_quote (bool)
- primary_city, address, suburbs (array), is_mobile (bool)
- phone, whatsapp, email, response_time, hours (jsonb — day: open/close), facebook_url, instagram_url, pixel_id, ga_measurement_id
- brand_colour (string key), logo_url, hero_photo_url, owner_photo_url, gallery_photos (array of urls)
- testimonials (jsonb array — name, suburb, quote)
- subdomain, custom_domain, site_published (bool), published_at (timestamp)
- subscription_status (active / cancelled / past_due), payfast_token, next_billing_date, created_at, updated_at

6.2 onboarding_progress table

- client_id (references clients)
- current_step (int 1–6), completed_steps (array), last_saved_at

Used to allow clients to return and resume onboarding without losing data.

7. Email Flows

All emails sent via Resend or Sendgrid. Use HTML templates — not plain text.

Feature	Description	Priority
Confirmation email	Sent immediately on publish. Contains: site URL, dashboard login link, 3-step setup checklist, payment receipt (amount, card last 4, next billing date). Subject: 'Your [Business name] website is live'	Required
Welcome / dashboard email	Sent with dashboard login credentials. Contains magic link or password setup link.	Required
Monthly receipt	Sent on each successful recurring charge. Contains amount, date, next billing date.	Required
Payment failed	Sent if recurring charge fails. Contains retry link and support contact.	Required
Cancellation confirmation	Sent when client cancels. Confirms end date, offers reactivation link.	Required

8. Billing — PayFast Integration

PayFast is the required payment processor for South Africa. The developer must implement the following:

- Initial payment of R300 collected on Step 5 of onboarding
- PayFast recurring subscription created on successful first payment — auto-charges on the same date each month
- PayFast ITN (Instant Transaction Notification) webhook must be implemented to update `subscription_status` in Supabase on each charge outcome
- Failed payment: set status to 'past_due', send failed payment email, show banner in client dashboard, suspend site after 7-day grace period
- Cancellation: client can cancel from dashboard — sets end date to end of current billing period, no refund needed after 30 days
- 30-day refund policy: implement manual refund flow in admin panel — not automated

Critical PayFast requirements

- Use PayFast sandbox environment during development and testing — never test with live keys
- Store PayFast subscription token securely in Supabase — never expose in client-side code
- Validate ITN signature on every webhook — reject invalid requests
- Test all payment states: success, failure, cancellation, retry

9. What Is NOT In Scope for MVP

The following features have been deliberately excluded from MVP to keep the build lean and on time. Do not build these unless explicitly instructed in writing.

Excluded from MVP — do NOT build

- AI colour extraction from logo (Color Thief) — replaced by 6-preset colour picker
- Live Google Reviews widget via Google Places API — replaced by static testimonials with a 'Connect' prompt in dashboard
- Facebook / Instagram API traffic integration — GA4 only for MVP dashboard
- Live 'Open now / Closed' indicator based on business hours — display hours as plain text only
- Autocomplete on suburb tag input — plain text tag input only
- Before / after photo pairs — single photo gallery upload only
- Online booking integration (Calendly, Setmore) — contact form and WhatsApp only
- Dental and real estate niche templates — HVAC only for MVP
- International payment processors — PayFast (South Africa) only
- Mobile app — web only

10. Delivery Milestones & Payment Structure

Payment is tied to milestone delivery. The developer will not receive full payment upfront. Each milestone requires review and written sign-off before the next payment is released.

M1 Project setup + database + auth

Week 1–2

- Next.js project initialised with Supabase connected
- Database schema created with row-level security enabled
- Supabase Auth working — client login and session management
- Basic admin panel shell with client list
- Vercel deployment pipeline configured
- PayFast sandbox credentials configured and test mode verified

Payment on milestone sign-off: 25% of agreed total

M2 Onboarding flow (all 6 steps)

Week 3–5

- All 6 onboarding steps built and functional
- Form validation on all required fields
- Progress auto-saved to Supabase on each step
- Logo upload and colour picker working
- Suburb tag input working
- PayFast payment integration on Step 5 — sandbox tested
- Blurred site preview on payment step
- Publish flow on Step 6 — subdomain creation and site deployment triggered

Payment on milestone sign-off: 25% of agreed total

M3 HVAC template + published site engine

Week 6–8

- Full HVAC template built with all sections specified in Section 5
- Template renders from Supabase client data — all fields dynamic
- Brand colour theming working across all 6 colour presets
- Floating WhatsApp button with pre-filled message
- Schema markup and SEO meta tags auto-generated
- Privacy policy page auto-generated
- Facebook Pixel injection working
- Google Analytics injection working
- Mobile-responsive — tested on iOS and Android

Payment on milestone sign-off: 25% of agreed total

M4 Dashboard + emails + billing webhooks

Week 9–11

- Client dashboard fully functional with all sidebar sections
- GA4 traffic data pulling and displaying in dashboard charts
- Setup checklist working and updating on completion
- Website edit functionality — client can update fields and re-publish
- Photo upload working from dashboard
- PayFast ITN webhook implemented and tested
- All 5 email flows built and tested
- Billing management in client dashboard (cancel, view receipts)
- Admin panel complete with full client management

Final payment on milestone sign-off: 25% of agreed total

11. Deliverables

On project completion, the developer must hand over the following:

- Full source code in a private GitHub repository — with the client added as owner
- Supabase project with all tables, RLS policies, and environment variables documented
- Vercel project connected to the repo with production deployment live
- PayFast live credentials integrated and tested in production
- README.md documenting: local setup instructions, environment variables required, deployment process, how to add a new niche template in future
- 30-day bug fix period after final handover — developer must fix any bugs found at no additional cost

Questions about this brief?

Respond in writing before starting any work.

All scope changes must be approved in writing. No verbal agreements will be honoured.